Evacuation Checklist

General safety information, not medical advice or a substitute for training. In an emergency, call 911.

From the free guide at https://jaechung-glitch.github.io/bugout/guides/what-to-do-when-told-to-evacuate/, which lists its sources. Updated November 12, 2026.

What to take

- [ ] Your go bag: at least 3 days of water, food and supplies
  See our bug out bag list.
- [ ] Medicines, glasses and medical devices with chargers
- [ ] IDs, insurance papers and medical records, or copies
- [ ] Cash and cards
- [ ] Phones, chargers and power banks
- [ ] A change of clothes, sturdy shoes and protective clothing
- [ ] Maps saved on your phone and on paper
- [ ] Pet food, water, leashes, carriers and records
- [ ] Baby supplies, if you need them

If you have time before you leave

- [ ] Tell someone outside the area that you're leaving and where you're going
- [ ] Lock doors and windows (for a wildfire, close them but leave them unlocked)
- [ ] Turn off utilities and unplug appliances if officials tell you to

- [ ] Bring in outdoor furniture and anything the wind could throw
- [ ] Leave a note saying when you left and where you went

On the road

- [ ] Follow the recommended evacuation route; shortcuts may be blocked or unsafe
- [ ] Watch for downed trees, washed-out roads and power lines
- [ ] Never drive into floodwater or around barricades
- [ ] Keep the radio on for updates

Tick items off on your iPhone. BugOut, the free offline survival app, lets you make your own checklists and keeps its guides on your phone with no signal.